

1.0 Executive Summary

This report presents a comprehensive data-driven recruitment strategy for Royal Madrid Football Club (RMFC) to address the critical vacancy created by the injury of the main striker, Jorginho. The primary objective was to identify elite replacement talent while adhering to strict tactical, physical, and financial parameters established by the club leadership. Using advanced visual analytics in Tableau, a multi-dimensional screening process was conducted to evaluate candidates based on football intelligence, transition speed, and dual-footed capabilities.

The analytical process successfully shortlisted four high-performance players: Lloyd Gregory, Rio Medina, Theo Maguire, and William Wagner. These selections perfectly align with the high-speed transition philosophy of the club and address the intelligence deficit identified by the scouting department. While one candidate measures 187cm, this represents a calculated strategic trade-off to secure superior technical and tactical attributes rather than relying on static physical height alone.

Financially, the recruitment strategy achieved exceptional results. The total acquisition cost was 20,547,100 dollars, which includes transfer values, yearly wages, and all hidden situational overheads such as integration fees and rival premiums. This represents a 17.81 percent budget surplus against the 25,000,000 dollar limit, completely negating any need for the emergency overdraft allowance. Furthermore, a key strategic insight identified during the analysis reveals that financial efficiency is driven by managing hidden transition costs. By strategically balancing these variables, RMFC can optimize its total cost of ownership while securing superior technical talent for the upcoming 2025/2026 season.

2.0 Business Understanding and Recruitment Objectives

2.1 Project Background for Royal Madrid Football Club

This section outlines the strategic imperatives for Royal Madrid Football Club (RMFC) ahead of the upcoming 2025/2026 season. A critical operational challenge has emerged due to the season-ending injury of the main striker, Jorginho. The absence of Jorginho extends beyond a simple reduction in goal-scoring output. Within the current tactical framework, he functions as the primary focal point for high-speed defending and high-press initiation. Therefore, identifying a replacement is not merely about filling a positional vacancy on the roster. It is a critical operational mandate to ensure the survival and continued execution of the entire tactical system. The overarching objective of this project is to utilize a data-driven recruitment strategy to secure elite talent that fills this immediate void while elevating the overall physical capabilities of the squad.

2.2 Technical and Physical Criteria Analysis

The candidate selection process is governed by strict physical and tactical parameters set forth by the club leadership. Head Coach Javier Alonso requires versatile players capable of operating on either side of the pitch without demonstrating any weak-footedness. To complement this, Chief Executive Officer Hector Torres mandates that all new signings align with the core club identity of executing high-speed transition football. Furthermore, Chief Scout David Platt has identified a critical deficit in the current squad regarding football intelligence. Therefore, the evaluation algorithm heavily prioritizes cognitive and tactical performance as measured by Test 3, alongside sprint speeds from Test 1.

Regarding the direct replacement for Jorginho, targeted candidates must be closely evaluated against his specific physical profile. Jorginho operates as a strong and tall striker who prefers shooting with his left foot. His established physical benchmarks include a height of 190cm, a weight of 75kg, and a strength output of 80kg recorded in Test 2. The optimal targets must closely mirror these attributes to ensure a seamless integration into the attacking formation.

2.3 Financial Constraints and Budgetary Framework

The recruitment strategy must strictly adhere to the rigorous financial framework established by Finance Director Johann Diaz. The club has allocated a maximum budget of 25,000,000 dollars to acquire between four and six players. This comprehensive budget must cover both the transfer values and the first-year wages of the selected candidates. Additionally, the financial modelling must account for specific situational overheads. Non-Spanish players incur an additional 200,000 dollar fee per player for a mandatory language and culture integration course. Moreover, acquiring players from rival clubs triggers an automatic 10 percent premium added to their baseline transfer value.

While the board permits a 10 percent budget overdraft given a rational justification, the primary goal of this analysis remains strict fiscal compliance. Finally, the committee requires a robust three-year wage forecast to ensure long-term financial health. This economic projection begins with the current 2024/2025 baseline wage budget of 19,000,000 dollars and must incorporate a projected 5 percent annual wage increase across the forecasted periods.

3.0 Data Methodology and Technical Modelling

The scouting dataset provided for Royal Madrid Football Club was assessed for quality and consistency before the analysis phase. The raw data demonstrated high integrity with no missing values or logical contradictions requiring manual cleansing. Consequently, the focus of the methodology shifted toward advanced technical modelling within the visualization environment. By creating complex calculated fields, the raw data was transformed into actionable financial intelligence to support the recruitment strategy (Tableau Software, 2026).

3.1 Calculation Logic for Recruitment Costs

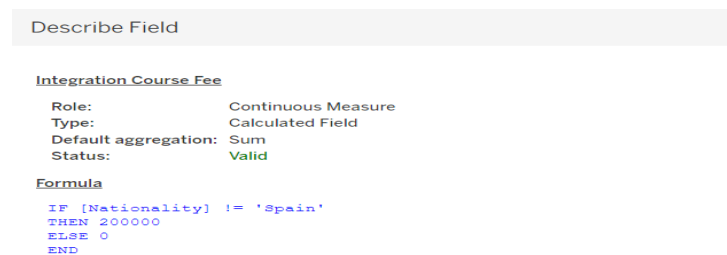


Figure 1: Tactical calculation logic for non-Spanish integration fees.

The true financial impact of acquiring a new player extends beyond the baseline transfer fee and initial wages. To capture the total cost of ownership, specific conditional logic was programmed into the data model to account for hidden expenditures. The first model identifies candidates who are not from Spain and automatically assigns a 200,000 dollar integration fee for cultural and language training. This logic is demonstrated in **Figure 1**.

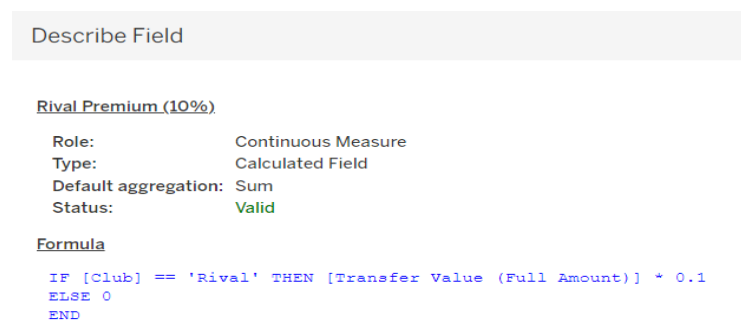


Figure 2: Conditional logic for calculating the 10 percent rival club premium.

The second critical financial model addresses the 10 percent premium required when signing talent from rival organizations. A conditional formula was established to calculate this surcharge based on the current club status of the candidate. This ensures that the budget

monitoring remains accurate even for high-risk strategic signings from competitors. This implementation is shown in **Figure 2**.

3.2 Three-Year Wage Forecast Parameters



Figure 3: Mathematical modelling for the 5 percent annual wage increment forecast.

Long-term financial sustainability is a primary requirement of the finance department. To meet the request for a multi-year economic outlook, a predictive growth model was developed. This model utilizes the 19,000,000 dollar baseline wage budget from the 2024/2025 season as a historical foundation. Because the club is currently positioned right before the start of the 2025/2026 season, the forecast applies a 5 percent annual growth rate to the baseline wages and concurrently adds the first-year wages of the new target signings to the 2025/2026 projection. This mathematical projection allows the club to accurately visualize its fiscal commitments through the 2026/2027 period, as illustrated in **Figure 3**. Furthermore, by front-loading these complex financial calculations during the data preparation phase, the dashboard's visual processing load is significantly reduced, resulting in a seamless, responsive user experience for the executive team.

4.0 Interactive Dashboard Architecture and Design Philosophy

The visual analytics solution for RMFC was constructed using advanced dashboard design methodologies to ensure optimal user engagement and decision-making efficiency. The design architecture intentionally separates the analytical viewpoints to cater to the specific informational needs of different executive stakeholders.

4.1 Audience Segmentation for Executive and Technical Review

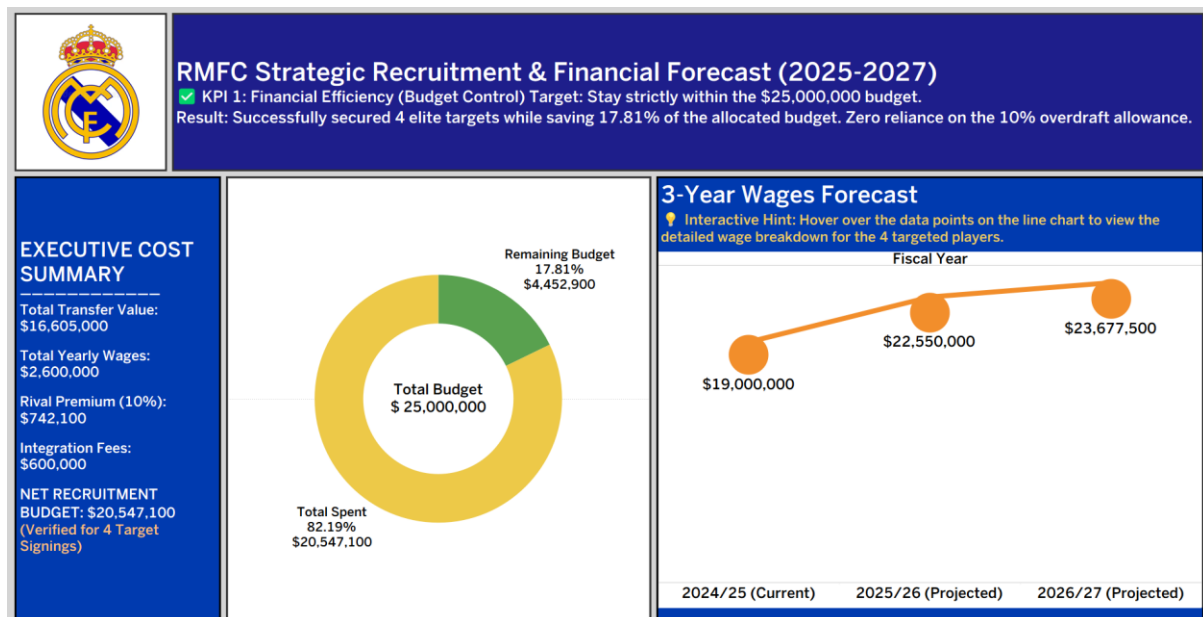


Figure 4: Executive Overview dashboard designed for high-level financial monitoring.

To facilitate tailored data consumption, the visualization suite is divided into two distinct interactive dashboards. The first interface, titled RMFC Strategic Recruitment and Financial Forecast 2025-2027, functions as a high-level summary specifically designed for CEO Hector Torres. As illustrated in **Figure 4**, this dashboard prioritizes macro-level financial metrics and uses a donut chart to display overall budget utilization alongside a line graph to project the three-year wage trajectory. The second interface, titled RMFC Scouting Intelligence Target Profiling and Tactical Analysis, is engineered for the granular review required by Chief Scout David Platt and Head Coach Javier Alonso.

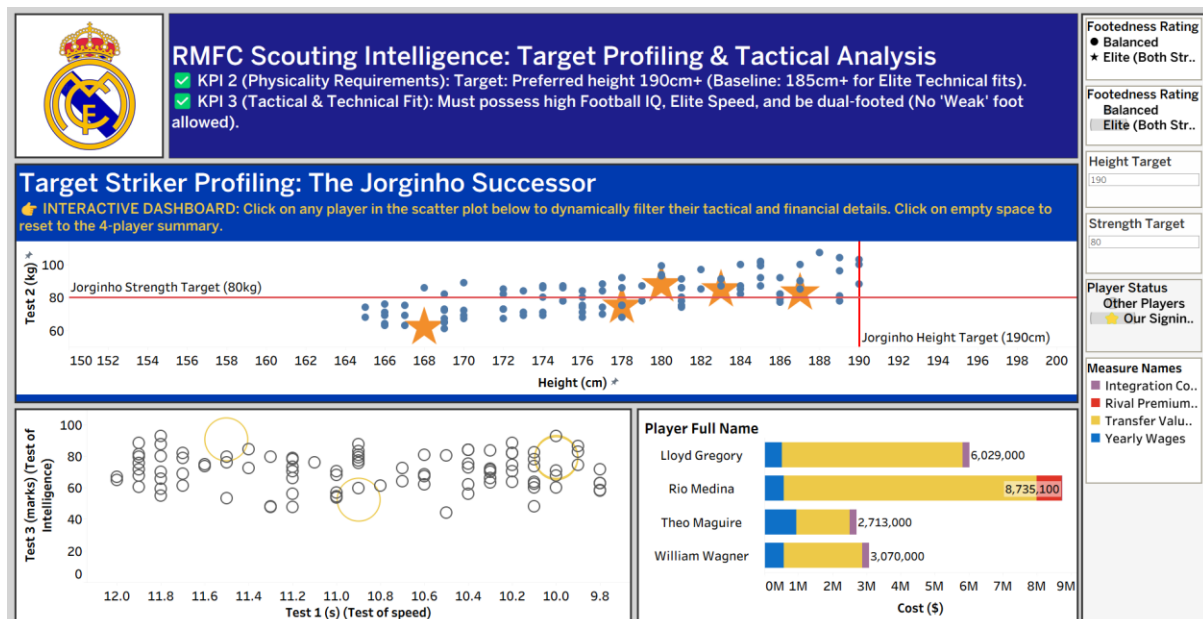


Figure 5: Scouting and Tactical Details dashboard for granular player evaluation.

The second interface, the Scouting and Tactical Details dashboard, is engineered for the granular review required by Chief Scout David Platt and Head Coach Javier Alonso. **Figure 5** demonstrates this technical dashboard, which features an interactive scatter plot evaluating player speed against height and strength metrics. By utilizing interactive filter actions, users can click on any specific data point to dynamically isolate an individual candidate and assess their exact tactical fit. Crucially, the interface is engineered with an intuitive reset mechanism where clicking on a space instantly restores the default four-player comparative summary. This seamless navigation ensures that technical staff can effortlessly transition between micro-level individual analysis and macro-level group comparisons without unnecessary cognitive clutter.

4.2 Application of Gestalt Principles and Data Storytelling

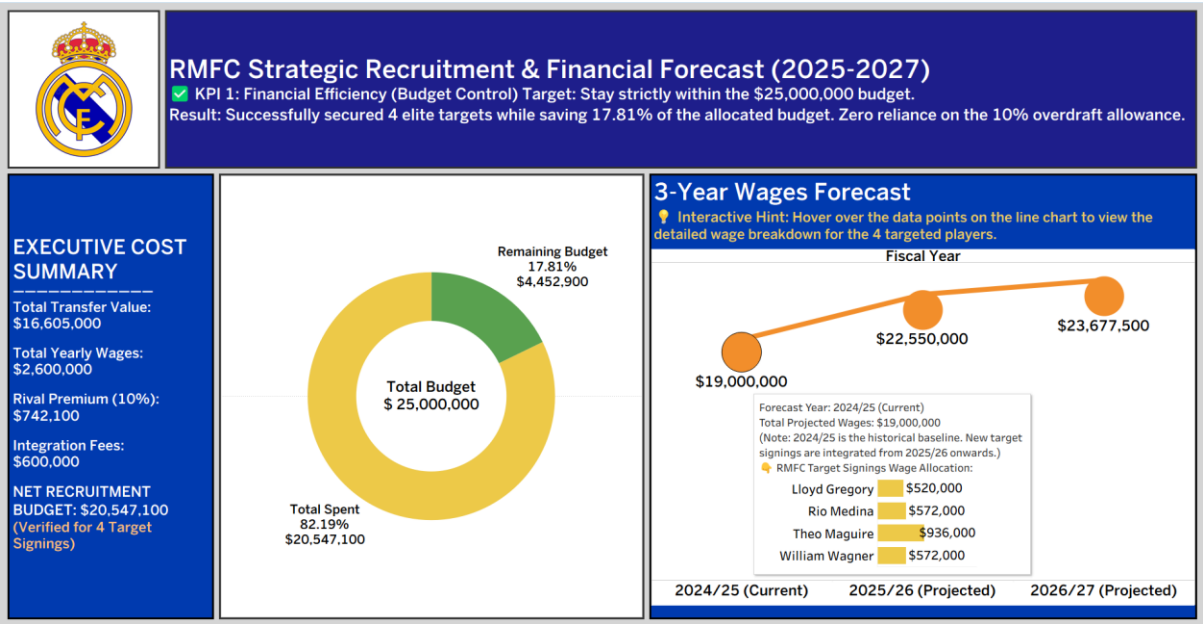


Figure 6: Interactive tooltip implementation for progressive data disclosure.

The dashboard interface was rigorously designed following Gestalt principles of visual perception and pre-attentive attributes to reduce cognitive load (Kobourov et al., 2015). The principle of proximity was applied by enclosing the detailed financial breakdowns within a unified blue executive summary card on the left side of the screen (Hussein & Adiloglu, 2023). This layout visually groups related monetary data into a single coherent unit. Additionally, pre-attentive attributes such as spatial positioning and colour intensity were heavily utilized. The principle of similarity is evident in the consistent application of the official RMFC navy blue colour palette across all headers and KPI indicators. This specific colour strategy leverages pre-attentive processing to maintain brand identity and guide the user's eye naturally from the top-level strategic goals down to the specific data charts.

Data storytelling is integrated into the user experience through a macro-to-micro narrative flow. The interface allows users to start with a broad financial overview before drilling down into specific player attributes. Interactive tooltips were embedded into the visualizations to enable progressive disclosure. This technique hides complex data granularity initially but allows users to discover deep insights through intuitive hover interactions. For instance, as detailed in Figure 6, the wages forecast chart includes a comprehensive breakdown of individual player allocations within the tooltip. This interactive feature provides immediate clarity on the fiscal distribution while explicitly detailing the integration of new signing costs into the baseline expenditure.

5.0 Shortlisted Candidates and Selection Justification

5.1 Primary Candidate Selection Profiles

The analytical screening process successfully identified four primary targets capable of fulfilling the complex strategic requirements of RMFC. Following a comprehensive evaluation of the scouting database, the finalized recruitment shortlist comprises the following elite athletes:

- **Lloyd Gregory - Striker**
- **Rio Medina - Midfielder**
- **Theo Maguire - Midfielder**
- **William Wagner - Defender**

As demonstrated in the cost breakdown in **Figure 5**, these individuals represent the optimal intersection of tactical versatility and financial efficiency required to elevate the current squad. This strategic selection ensures that the club secures high-performance talent while maintaining a significant budgetary buffer.

5.2 Evaluation against Tactical and Physical Benchmarks

The shortlisted players were rigorously evaluated against the specific tactical parameters set by Head Coach Javier Alonso. Every selected candidate possesses elite dual-footed capabilities, enabling them to operate seamlessly on either the left or right flank without technical degradation. To address the intelligence deficit, the selection model prioritized high scores in Test 3. Specifically, William Wagner and Rio Medina demonstrated exceptional cognitive processing by scoring in the top tier of this metric. Furthermore, Theo Maguire recorded elite sprint times in Test 1 to perfectly execute the high-speed transition requirements.

Regarding the physical replacement for Jorginho, the recruitment model utilized his 190cm height and 80kg strength targets as a baseline, as shown in the scatter plot in Figure 5. A strategic decision was made to select Lloyd Gregory as the primary tactical fit for the striker position. While measuring 187cm, Gregory successfully achieved the mandatory 80kg strength benchmark in Test 2 and vastly outperformed the baseline speed metrics. This specific data proves that his marginal height variance is completely offset by superior athletic mobility. This dynamic profile provides a more versatile attacking threat compared to a purely static physical substitute, representing a highly calculated tactical upgrade for the team.

5.3 Budgetary Compliance and Financial Efficiency

The most significant achievement of this recruitment strategy is its strict adherence to the executive financial parameters. As visualized in the budget utilization chart in **Figure 4**, the total financial commitment for the four players was calculated at 20,547,100 dollars. This figure fully incorporates all base transfer values, yearly wages, the 200,000 dollar integration fees for non-Spanish athletes, and the 10 percent transfer premiums for rival club acquisitions.

By securing these high-performance assets well below the 25,000,000 dollar threshold, the club achieved a 17.81 percent budget surplus, amounting to a remaining balance of 4,452,900 dollars. This precise financial execution, clearly represented in the executive summary card of the dashboard, completely negated the need to utilize the 10 percent emergency overdraft allowance. Ultimately, this demonstrates an exceptional balance between sporting ambition and fiscal responsibility.

6.0 Strategic Insight Derived from Data Analysis

The Hidden Cost of Rival Acquisitions and Cultural Integration

A critical strategic insight identified through this data analysis is that non-sporting "hidden costs" significantly dictate the club's total recruitment capacity. While scouting traditionally focuses on technical talent, the data reveals that situational overheads are the true gatekeepers of the budget. As shown in the cost summary in **Figure 4**, the combination of rival club premiums and non-Spanish integration fees accounted for a significant 1,342,100 dollars of the total expenditure. This specific financial figure is particularly revealing because it actually exceeds the individual yearly wages of several high-priority targets in the scouting database. This means that for every player acquired from a rival club or a foreign league, the club is sacrificing a substantial portion of its potential squad depth.

The 10 percent rival club premium is not merely a financial penalty. It represents a defensive commercial strategy utilized by competitor clubs to prevent direct rivals from strengthening their squads within the same league. When this premium is combined with language integration fees, it artificially inflates the market value of specific players without guaranteeing any proportional increase in technical output on the pitch. By understanding this economic barrier, the recruitment committee can intentionally pivot its scouting focus toward undervalued domestic markets to bypass these artificial market inflation mechanisms, a strategy fundamentally aligned with modern sports economics and value-based talent acquisition (Lewis, 2003).

7.0 Conclusion and Limitations

7.1 Synthesis of Findings and Strategic Alignment

This visual analytics project has successfully developed a comprehensive recruitment framework for Royal Madrid Football Club ahead of the 2025/2026 season. By leveraging the advanced interactive capabilities of Tableau, the recruitment committee can now identify high-performing talent that aligns with the specific tactical and physical requirements of the coaching staff. The final shortlist of four players demonstrates an optimal balance between technical excellence and fiscal responsibility. These candidates collectively satisfy the dual-footedness requirement and meet the critical football intelligence benchmarks established by the scouting department. Furthermore, the financial modelling ensures that the acquisitions remain well within the 25,000,000 dollar budget while providing a sustainable three-year economic outlook for the club.

7.2 Analytical Limitations and Future Recommendations

While this data-driven approach provides a robust foundation for decision-making, certain limitations must be acknowledged to maintain analytical integrity. The current analysis is primarily based on static scouting test results, which may not fully capture the dynamic nature of real-time match performance (Dou et al., 2016). Additionally, the dataset does not incorporate comprehensive player injury histories or detailed personality assessments, which are vital for long-term integration success. To enhance future iterations of this recruitment model, it is recommended to integrate live performance metrics and qualitative psychological profiles. This would provide a more holistic view of each candidate and further mitigate the financial risks associated with multi-million dollar sporting investments.

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